

Carolina and Representative John E. Rankin of Mississippi. Both come from poll-tax states where you have to pay to vote. As PM pointed out, Rankin owes his political career to the high art of keeping the vote low. In 1942 when he was reelected as usual, only 7,079 votes were cast for him, though the population of his district is given as 263,367. No wonder he believes in the state's right to keep the vote to a manageable size.

Naturally the people who put through the substitute measure don't admit that they don't want you to vote. The very suggestion not only outrages them; it moves them to tears that a crocodile would envy. They rest their case—on the Constitution! Listen, for instance, to "Cotton Ed" Smith. "Mr. President," he said, "I have one platform on which I shall live and die—my loyalty to the Constitution, my loyalty to states' rights, and my loyalty to white supremacy." He apparently never heard of the Fifteenth Amendment, which contains that little phrase about "race, color, or previous condition of servitude." Then he went on to tell a filthy joke about Negroes—on the floor of the United States Senate.

The question is now before the House, but apparently it isn't going to be voted on there until after the Christmas recess. Let's hope all your friends and relatives at home make such a fuss in the meantime that our duly elected representatives won't dare disfranchise you for the duration—and blame it on the Constitution. I'm designing a special New Year's card to send to Representative Rankin and Senator Smith. It's printed on asbestos.

M. M.

Crocodile Tears

LITERALLY," Assistant Secretary of State Breckinridge Long told the House Foreign Affairs Committee the other day, "the reports of the consular officers to the Department of State form one of the most thrilling and one of the most saddening and awful pages of our humanitarian history." We agree with Mr. Long, though in a sense other than he intended. "We have taken into this country since the beginning of the Hitler regime and the persecution of the Jews, until today," he said, "approximately 580,000 refugees." These figures were intended to impress the committee with the State Department's generosity. Figures could hardly be more deceptive. In the decade 1923-33 more than two million immigrants entered this country. The number given by Mr. Long for the Hitler decade is 75 per cent lower than for the pre-Hitler decade. It is false to describe these 580,000, as he did, as "refugees."

For the nine-year period 1933 to 1942, of 453,205 immigrants admitted to the United States, only 291,112 came from Europe. The rest were from non-European countries, with Mexico and Canada heading the list. Of the European immigrants, 243,420 came from countries

now dominated by Hitler, and of all the immigrants during this period, 163,423 were Jews. "We did every legitimate thing we could do," Mr. Long declared. The best answer is the figures on immigration from the Reich itself since Hitler came to power. The annual German quota was 25,957. From the beginning of 1933 to the end of 1942 we admitted 123,573 immigrants from the Reich, less than half quota allotments. Here are the figures by years: 1933, 1,324; 1934, 3,515; 1935, 3,891; 1936, 6,073; 1937, 11,127; 1938, 17,868. In 1938 came the Anschluss, which added the Austrian quota of 1,413 to the German quota of 25,957. It was not until 1939 that we eased up on restrictions which had kept German immigration below quota since Hitler came to power. In 1939 we admitted 32,759 immigrants from Germany and Austria. Since then admissions have been below the combined quota (27,370). In 1940 admissions of German nationals were 26,083; in 1941 they were 15,051; in 1942 they were 4,883. The number admitted fell after the war began on the basis of a new excuse: Gestapo agents were invading the country behind rabbinical beards. The door, as Mr. Long said, "is open" but "carefully screened." Considering the thousands of applications, it should have been possible, if the department had been really generous, to do that "screening" and still admit the full quota each year.

Mr. Long made much of the fact that visitors' visas were used to permit some entries above quota, and gave the impression that this was largely to help Jewish refugees. In the fiscal year ending June 30, 1942, the number entering on visitors' visas was 82,457 (2,292 of them Jews), the number departing 67,189 (1,250 of them Jews). Net: 15,268 on visitors' visas, -1,042 Jews. Most of the visitors were just visitors. In the last half of last year the net remaining on visitors' visas was 8,688, of which 134 were Jews. We do not believe that Jews require or ask more consideration than any other anti-fascist refugees, but they deserve at least as much. In the light of those figures we think it was hypocritical and unfair of Long to tell the committee that the State Department "cannot exclude persons from our sympathy and our sympathetic attention if they are not Jews," and thus inspire Mundt of South Dakota to reply, "It seems to me that would be treading a pretty dangerous path. It is sort of doing the Hitler thing in reverse." On the contrary, all that is asked is that Jewish refugees get as sympathetic consideration as non-Jewish and that some agency be established, as suggested by the Baldwin-Rogers resolution, to help save the stateless Jews of occupied Europe who have no government to speak for them. The need for some such agency, and the danger of leaving the fate of these people in the hands of professional Anglo-American diplomats, is thoroughly demonstrated by Long's attempt to confuse the issue and mislead the House Foreign Affairs Committee.